Business Brain Quiz League

Season 3 · GW 6



Before we start

- 48 questions across 6 rounds, two per player per round.
- One round has 20-second videos.
- **Hands and eyes on screen.**
- **No tie-breakers.**
- Timer starts after the video or image zoom.
- Consistent, strict timing gets the game done in 45 minutes.

Round 1

Players 1–4 · two questions each

1.

- **Which brand**'s advertising campaign featuring a suave, silver-haired "Most Interesting Man in the World" inspired a series of memes built around the format "I don't always..., but when I do..."?



1.

DOS EQUIS beer

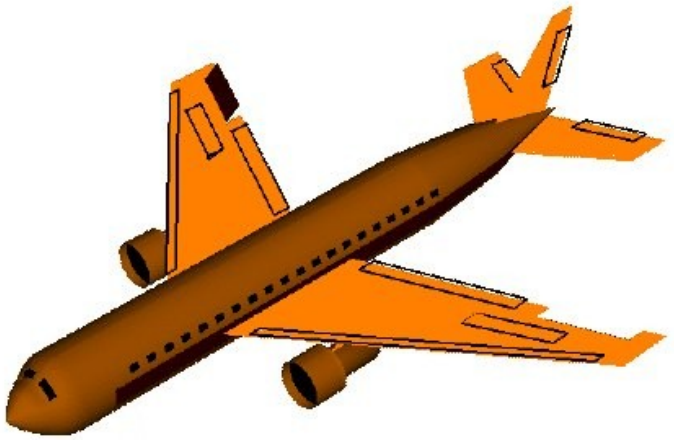


2.

- Following their 1903 breakthrough at Kitty Hawk, the Wright brothers patented a flight control mechanism that combined a vertical rudder with wing-warping.
- Rival inventor Glenn Curtiss bypassed their design using hinged flap surfaces mounted on the wing edges, leading to endless lawsuits that threatened U.S. air defense during World War I.
- **What flight control surfaces,** named after the French word for “little wing”, were at the epicenter of this aviation patent war?

2.

AILERON



3.

- Co-founded in 2018 by Shashvat Nakrani, Ashneer Grover and Bhavik Koladiya, this fintech unicorn transformed offline merchant payments across India by introducing zero-MDR interoperable QR codes.
- Well-known by its merchant-facing trade name, its founders registered the parent holding company under a name meant to signify durability, strength, and the capacity to adapt quickly to regulatory shifts.
- **What is the legal corporate name of this parent entity?**

3.

RESILIENT Innovations Private Limited



4.

- **What takeover countermeasure**, which takes its name from the star of a 1980 arcade game who turns on the ghosts chasing him, sees a target company try to buy its would-be buyer?

- Cities Service tried it against Mesa Petroleum, and Martin Marietta, a forerunner of Lockheed Martin, used it in 1982 against Bendix.

4.

PACMAN defense



5.

- On 1 June 1980, a new channel started broadcasting from Atlanta as the first TV channel to offer the “World’s first 24-hour television news channel”.
- **Which media owner**, already known for his TBS superstation, founded the channel?

5.

Ted TURNER



6.

- His memoir titled ‘Mind without Fear’ came out in 2019.
- He has been a Board member for companies like Goldman Sachs, P&G and American Airlines.
- **Name this former CEO** whose fraudulent dealings landed him in a big soup, where even Kofi Annan’s recommendation couldn’t help him much.

6.

Rajat GUPTA



7.

- **Which 190 m tower** in Malmö, Sweden, the second-tallest building in Scandinavia, has an official name that sounds like a nickname, taken from a marble sculpture by its own architect?

- Its nine five-storey blocks rotate 90 degrees from base to top, like *doing a classic gym warm-up trunk rotation*.



7.

TURNING TORSO

- Only the exact two words are acceptable



8.

- During the 2013 Super Bowl power outage, **which brand** tweeted “You can still dunk in the dark” in a real-time marketing moment that became legendary?



8.

OREO

Power out? No problem.



Round 2

Players 1–4 · two questions each

9.

- In 1720, as investors rushed into John Blunt’s South Sea Company, Parliament passed a law against rival share schemes, many of them *inflated*, *highly speculative* ventures with no real assets.
- The company itself backed the law, but it helped set off a wider crash.
- **What six-letter word** completes its popular nickname, the [BLANK] Act?

9.

BUBBLE Act

- Its official title was the Royal Exchange and London Assurance Corporation Act.



10.

- In 1998, this Scottish whisky maker overhauled its packaging to highlight its signature triangular bottle shape, originally created in 1961 by modernist designer Hans Schleger.
- The three-sided glass vessel was engineered to symbolize the three core elements of single malt production: water, air, and malted barley.
- **Which brand?**

10.

GLENFIDDICH



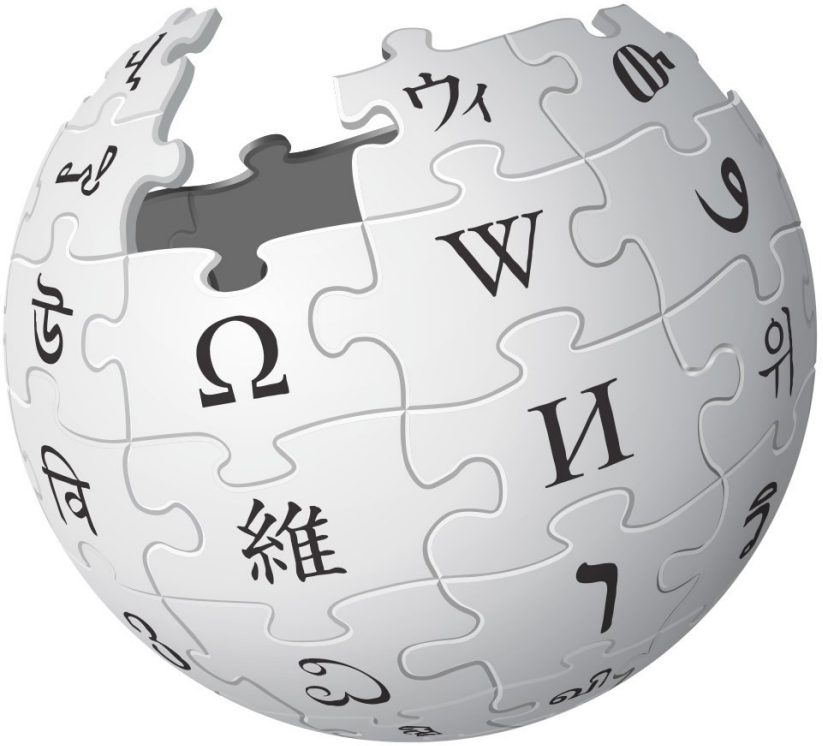
11.

- **Name the internet entrepreneur,** born in Huntsville, Alabama, who co-founded Bomis, a web portal whose adult-content business helped finance an ambitious online encyclopaedia project.
- When that project’s expert-review process proved too slow, he launched a more open, collaboratively edited side project with Larry Sanger in 2001.

11.

Jimmy WALES

- Co-founder of Wikipedia



12.

- Home to one of the highest-volume single-site hospital complexes in the world, the Chang Gung Medical Foundation operates a non-profit medical network exceeding 11,000 total beds, anchored by a flagship medical campus in Taoyuan.

- **In which Asian country/territory** is this healthcare foundation located?

12.

TAIWAN

- Accept Taipei

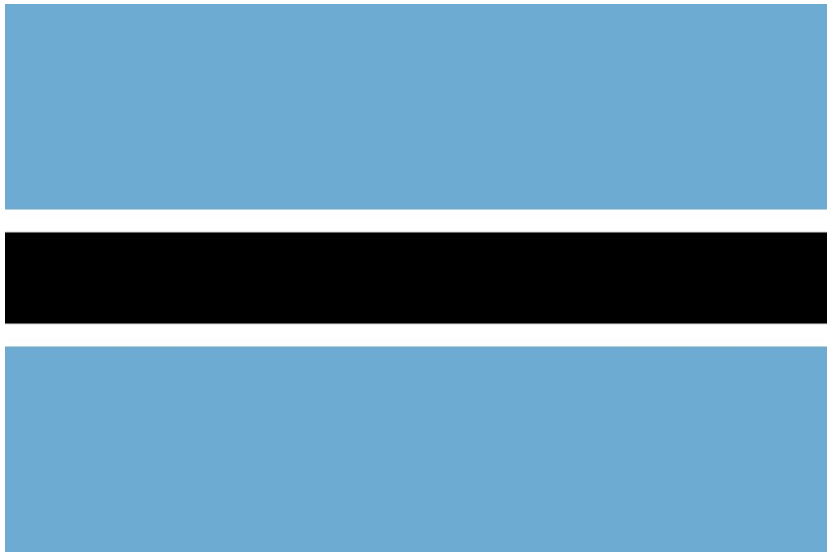


13.

- The UN created the Least Developed Countries (LDC) category in 1971 for the poorest nations.
- **Which landlocked sub-Saharan African country** became the first to graduate from the LDC category in 1994?
- Its transformation was driven largely by the discovery and export of diamonds (the largest producer in Africa), alongside prudent economic management.

13.

BOTSWANA



14.

- This 2025 Super Bowl ad for Hellmann’s mayonnaise brings back both original stars of a 1989 romantic comedy, written by Nora Ephron and directed by Rob Reiner, with Sydney Sweeney delivering its most quoted line.

- **Which film inspired it?**



▶ Watch on YouTube

14.

WHEN HARRY MET SALLY...



15.

- After a short stint at McKinsey, he joined his current organization working his way up to the top.
- He was once rumoured to replace Jason Goldman at Twitter.
- He was awarded the 2021 ‘Asia Game Changer Award’ by the Asia Society.
- Id this person, currently heading a global giant.

15.

Sundar PICHAI



16.

- **What business effect,** where customers stop buying a product after a company announces its replacement too early, is named after the US maker of the first commercially successful portable computer, which went bankrupt in 1983?

- Its British founder, born in Bangkok, spent part of his childhood in Tamil Nadu and died in Kodaikanal.

16.

OSBORNE effect



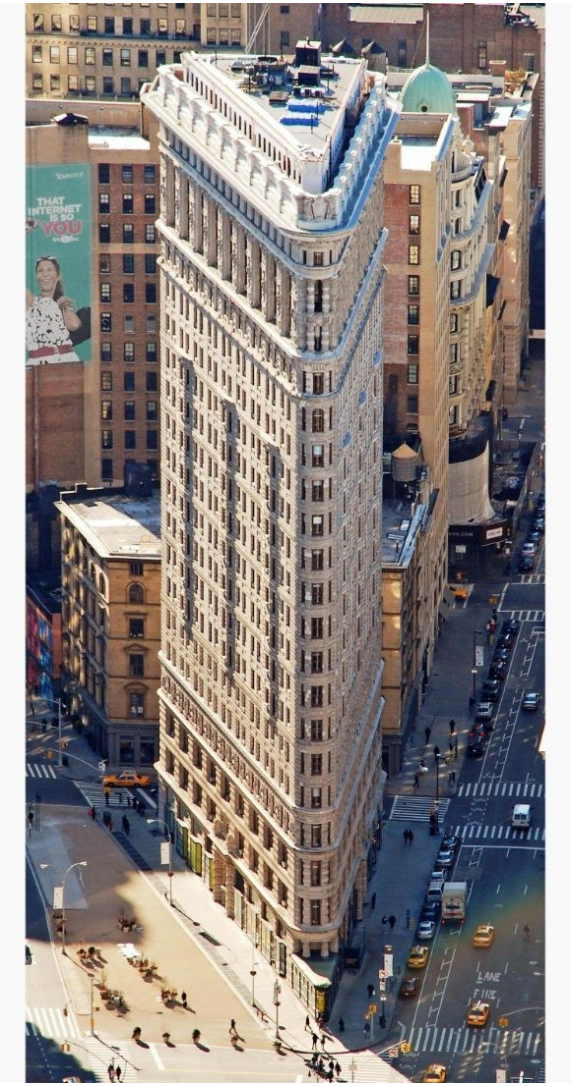
Round 3

Players 1–4 · two questions each

17.

- **Which New York landmark,** designed by Daniel Burnham’s firm and opened in 1902 as the Fuller Building, was nicknamed after a household object because of its triangular shape?

- After a failed $190 million auction bid in 2023, the office tower is being turned into luxury flats.



17.

FLATIRON



18.

- Controlling prominent hospital networks like Parkway, Pantai, and Gleneagles, as well as Turkey’s Acıbadem Healthcare Group, IHH Healthcare spans over 80 hospitals across 10 countries and is backed by Mitsui & Co. alongside sovereign wealth fund Khazanah Nasional.

- **What Southeast Asian nation** hosts the global headquarters of this private healthcare giant?

MALAYSIA

IHH Healthcare

19.

- In 1846, dentist William T. G. Morton patented a chemical preparation he called “Letheon,” a liquid whose pungent odour was disguised with aromatic oils.
- He attempted to secure royalties from hospitals whenever the preparation was used, sparking a major legal dispute over the ownership of a medical breakthrough.
- **What medical procedure or application** was Morton seeking to patent?

19.

Surgical ANESTHESIA



20.

- In 1915, the Root Glass Company of Terre Haute, Indiana, entered a competition to create a bottle so distinctive that its contents could be recognised “by feel in the dark.”
- Designers Earl R. Dean and Chapman J. Root drew inspiration from the ribbed form of a cocoa pod, producing a silhouette that would eventually become one of the most recognisable in the world.
- **Which brand** is inseparably associated with this bottle?

20.

COCA-COLA



21.

- In 2010, two IIT Bombay graduates founded a venture originally called OlaCabs.
- Its parent company’s name is a three-letter word formed by altering one letter in a Sanskrit-derived term meaning “primitive,” “original,” or “first.”
- **What is the corporate name of this parent entity that operates the flagship Ola ride-hailing network?**

21.

ANI Technologies Private Limited



22.

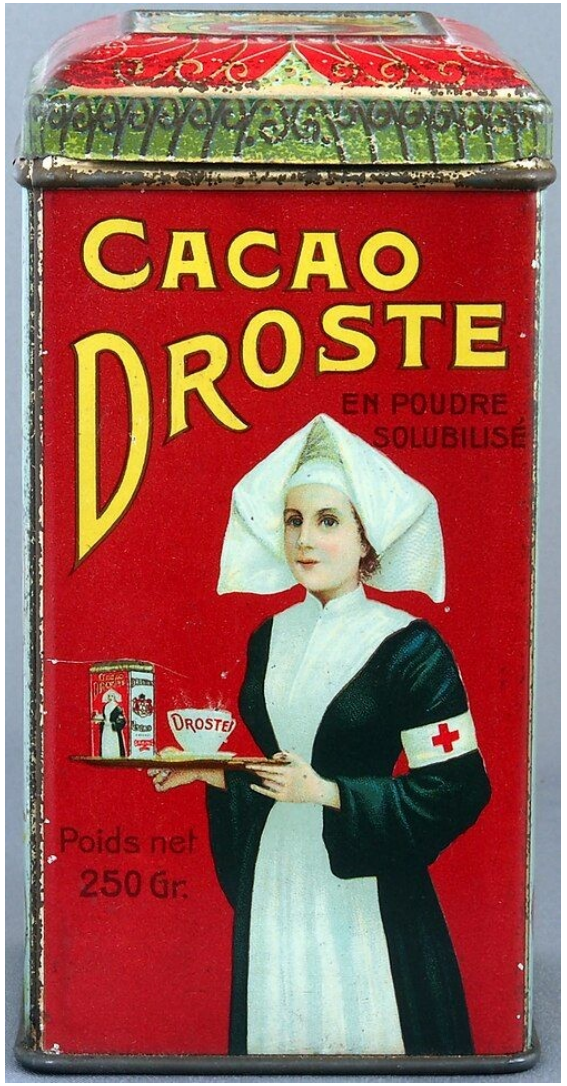
- **What term** describes a picture that appears inside itself, again and again, creating an apparently endless sequence?

- Giotto used this idea in an altarpiece in the early 14th century, but the term is named after a Dutch cocoa brand founded in 1863, whose early 20th-century tin depicted a nurse carrying a tray with a cup and a box bearing the same image.

22.

DROSTE effect

- The nurse-with-a-tray illustration first appeared on Droste products around 1900; the image recurs on the package she holds.



23.

- In the 1840s, Britain was gripped by an obsessive investment frenzy driven by George Hudson, the self-proclaimed “[BLANK] King” (7).
- Investors of all social classes poured life savings into unbuilt routes, seduced by guaranteed dividends paid out of capital rather than operating revenue.
- When the bubble burst in 1847, Hudson was exposed for corporate fraud, and the crisis triggered a nationwide financial collapse known by **what two-word (7, 5) historical name?**
- The blank will fetch you points.

23.

RAILWAY Mania



24.

- Founded in 1983 by Dr. Prathap C. Reddy, Apollo Hospitals revolutionized private healthcare by introducing modern multi-specialty tertiary care centers, expanding into over 70 tertiary facilities and 5,000 retail pharmacies across South Asia.

- **In which country** is this hospital conglomerate based?

24.

INDIA



Round 4

Players 1–4 · two questions each

25.

- This 2020 Super Bowl ad for Mountain Dew Zero Sugar has Bryan Cranston and Tracee Ellis Ross recreating scenes from a horror film based on a Stephen King novel.
- **Which film inspired it?**



▶ Watch on YouTube

25.

The SHINING



26.

- This former McKinsey employee is the writer of a couple of best-selling books.
- Once an aerobics instructor while studying at Harvard, she had worked for Google too and later went on to be a senior leader and elected to the Board of Directors of another global tech leader.
- **Name this person.**

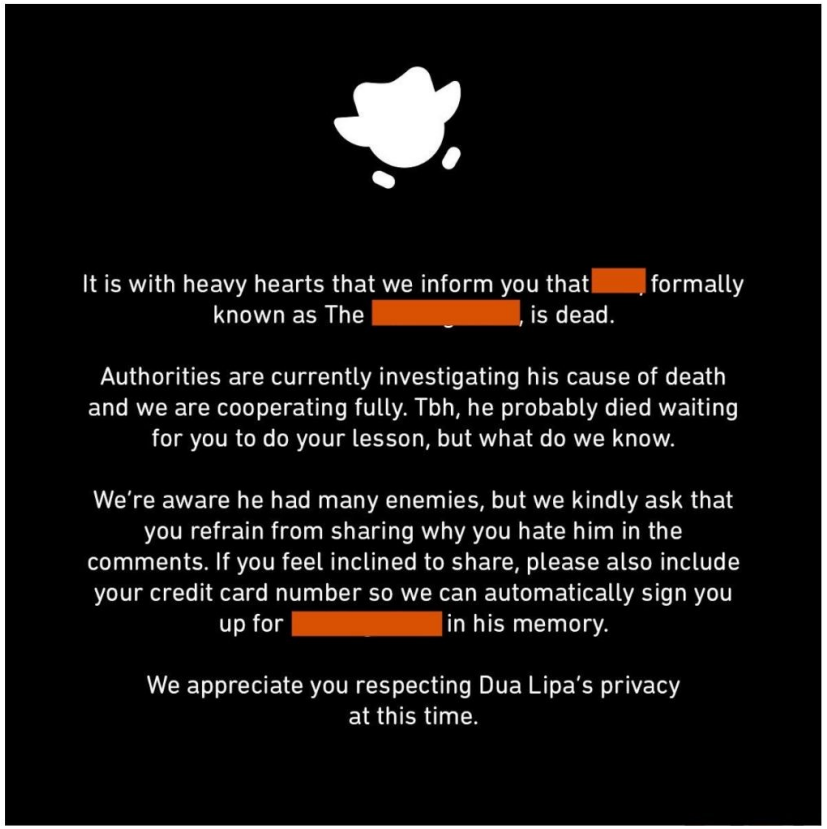
26.

Sheryl SANDBERG



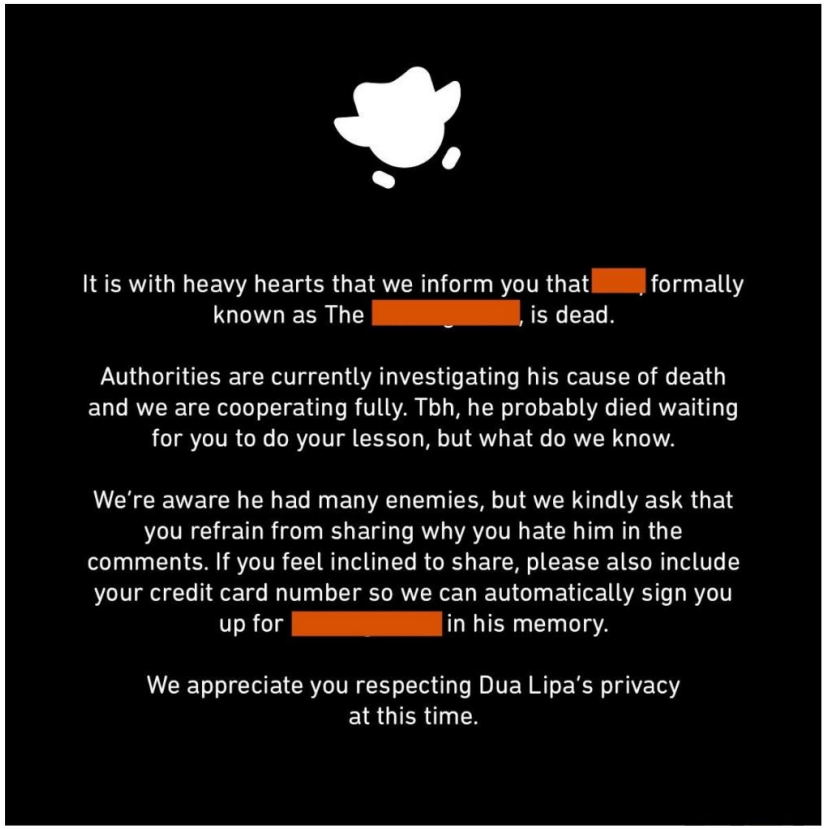
27.

- Obsessed with Dua Lipa and notorious for pestering users to complete their daily lessons, which app staged a fake death for its mascot?



27.

DUOLINGO


It is with heavy hearts that we inform you that [redacted], formally known as The [redacted], is dead.
Authorities are currently investigating his cause of death and we are cooperating fully. Tbh, he probably died waiting for you to do your lesson, but what do we know.
We're aware he had many enemies, but we kindly ask that you refrain from sharing why you hate him in the comments. If you feel inclined to share, please also include your credit card number so we can automatically sign you up for [redacted] in his memory.
We appreciate you respecting Dua Lipa's privacy at this time.

28.

- **What household tool** gives its nickname to Shanghai’s second-tallest building, a 492 m tower opened in 2008?

- Its top was first meant to have a round hole, but critics said it looked too much like the rising sun on the Japanese flag, so the design was changed to a trapezoid.



28.

BOTTLE OPENER

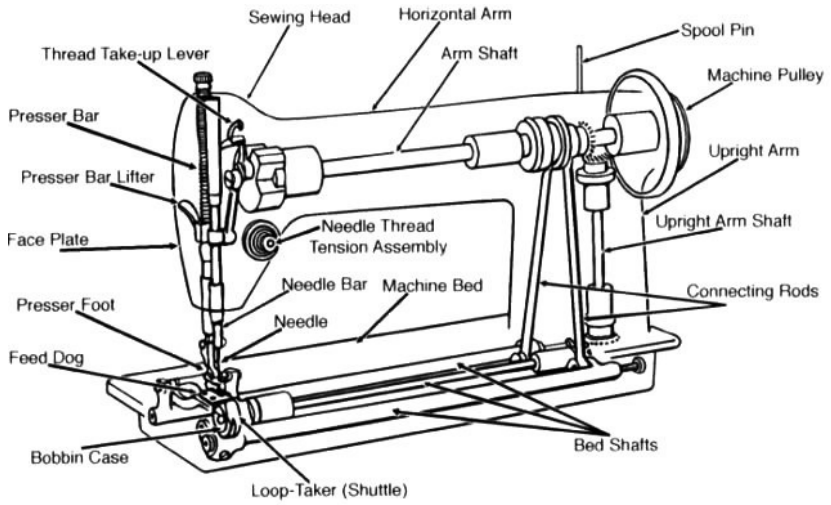


29.

- In the mid-19th century, four fierce rivals—Elias Howe, Isaac Singer, Nathaniel Wheeler, and Grover & Baker—were embroiled in endless lawsuits over essential machine parts.
- Realizing litigation was bankrupting everyone, they combined their intellectual property in 1856 to create the first major patent pool in American history.
- **What specific type of household manufacturing machine** was governed by this historic legal trust?

29.

SEWING MACHINE



HEAD (Front View)

30.

- **What Dutch name** was given to the trade in tulip contracts in taverns during the 1634–37 tulip mania, since no bulbs actually changed hands and buyers were in effect trading only promises of future delivery?

- (The Dutch word is 10 letters; English translation acceptable.)

30.

WINDHANDEL (or WINTHANDEL)

- Accept **“wind trade”** or **“trading in wind”**



31.

- This 2012 Super Bowl ad for the Honda CR-V stars Matthew Broderick, playing himself, skipping work for a day of fun that echoes his best-known role in a 1986 John Hughes comedy.
- **Which film inspired it?**



▶ Watch on YouTube

31.

FERRIS BUELLER’S DAY OFF



32.

- **Name the Parisian translator** and advertising agent who turned his foreign news bureau into a full news agency in 1835, widely called the world’s first.
- In 1940 the Vichy state took over its news side, which became Agence France-Presse in 1944, while its advertising arm kept his family name and is now one of the world’s largest advertising groups.

32.

Charles-Louis HAVAS



Round 5

Players 1–4 · two questions each

33.

- **What effect**, named after a breakfast cereal, makes floating pieces of cereal in milk drift together and cling to the side of the bowl?
- Far from a joke, it was the subject of a 2005 paper in the American Journal of Physics, which showed how surface tension bends the liquid and pulls the pieces together.



33.

CHEERIOS effect



34.

- Long before it became a payments giant, this enterprise started in 2000 as a mobile Value-Added Services vendor providing news, cricket scores, and ringtones to telecom operators.
- Its corporate name is a direct homage to the landline directory enquiry shortcode operated across India by BSNL.
- **What is the legal name of Paytm’s parent holding company?**

34.

ONE97 Communications Limited



35.

- In 1995, The New York Times named this former McKinsey employee as among the top 3 business experts who were in high demand as speakers.
- He admitted that he had fudged data for his seminal work, which he had co-authored with Robert Waterman.
- He had even served as a senior drug-abuse advisor under the Nixon administration.
- **Name him.**

35.

Tom PETERS

McKinsey&Company

36.

- **Which Asian country**, the largest among the UN’s 44 least developed countries (LDCs) with a population of 178 million, was scheduled to graduate from this category in 2026 but has requested a three-year extension, citing the challenges of its ongoing political & economic transition?

36.

BANGLADESH



37.

- Europe’s largest private hospital group, Fresenius Helios, operates over 80 acute-care facilities and hundreds of outpatient centers, having grown out of its parent healthcare group founded in Bad Homburg.

- **In which European country** is this massive hospital network headquartered?

37.

GERMANY



38.

- In 2009, a major American beverage company commissioned the Arnell Group to overhaul the packaging of one of its best-known juice brands.
- The redesign replaced a familiar fruit-and-straw motif with a more minimalist treatment, including a rounded cap intended to evoke the fruit itself.
- Sales plunged by 20% in just two months, reportedly costing the company more than $30 million in lost revenue, before the brand returned to its earlier identity.
- **Which brand** underwent this ill-fated redesign?

38.

TROPICANA



39.

- Inventor Elisha Gray filed a legal document on February 14, 1876, describing a variable-resistance liquid transmitter designed to convert sound into electric currents.

- Because another inventor filed his application just hours earlier, a decades-long war erupted over who held priority rights to **which common device?**

39.

TELEPHONE



40.

- When this former investment banker established her e-commerce venture in 2012, she incorporated the parent holding firm as FSN E-Commerce Ventures—using her own initials.
- For the public-facing brand, however, she chose a name derived from the Sanskrit word meaning “one in the spotlight.”
- **What is this popular Indian retailer?**

40.

NYKAA



Round 6

Players 1–4 · two questions each

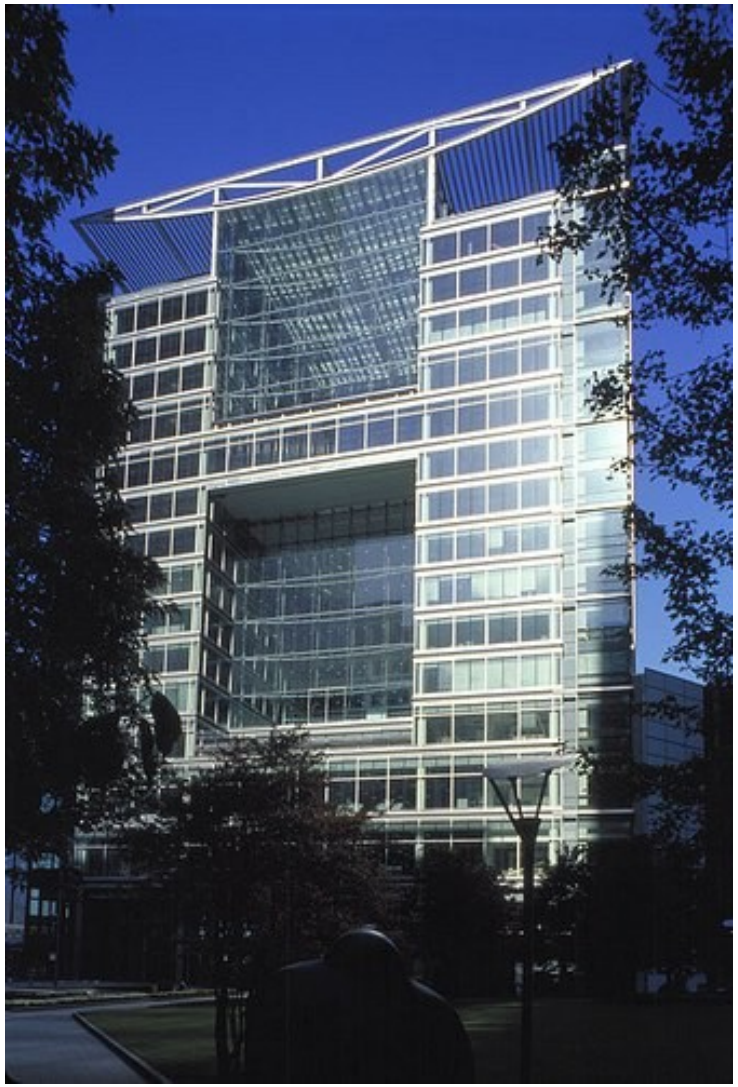
41.

- **Which news pioneer**, born in Kassel in 1816 as the son of a rabbi, worked for Havas in Paris and then used carrier pigeons in 1850 to fly news and stock prices between Aachen and Brussels?

- He moved to London, opened an office near the stock exchange in 1851, and set up his own news agency.

41.

Paul REUTER



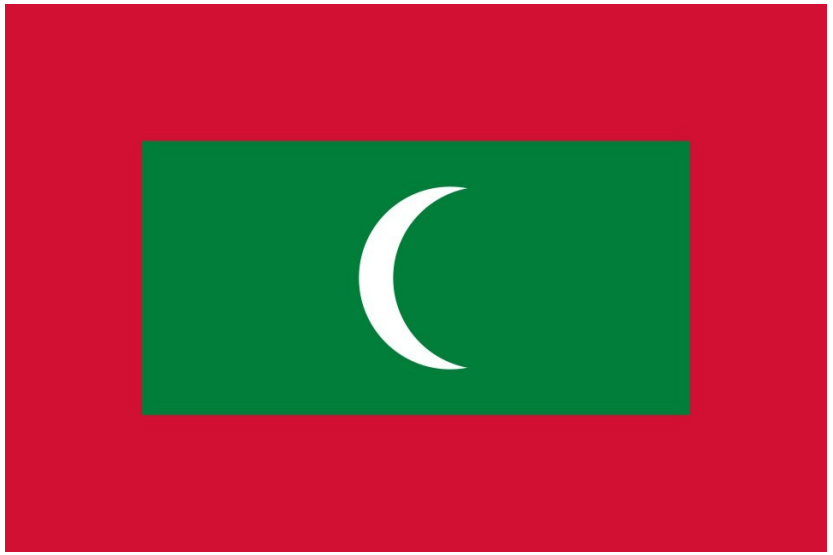
42.

- **Which country,** the smallest in Asia by land area, met the UN thresholds to leave the Least Developed Country category in 2004 due to growth in tourism and tuna exports, but received a three-year extension following a major tsunami before graduating in 2011?

- Its nominal GDP per capita has risen 5 times between 2000 and 2025.

42.

MALDIVES



43.

- In 1719, Scottish economist John Law merged his banking system with a company holding exclusive trading rights to French Louisiana.
- Promises of riches along the [BLANK] River (11) fuelled a speculative frenzy that ended in financial ruin.
- **What geographically named bubble** was this?

43.

MISSISSIPPI BUBBLE

- Also accept Mississippi Scheme



44.

- This 2008 Super Bowl ad for the Audi R8 recreates the most shocking wake-up scene from an all-time classic, and even features Alex Rocco, an actor from the original film.

- **Which film inspired it?**



▶ Watch on YouTube

44.

The GODFATHER



45.

- Known for its sharp, sarcastic Twitter persona and merciless roasts of rival fast-food chains, **which chain**’s social media team agreed in 2017 to give a teenager a year’s supply of chicken nuggets if his tweet reached 18 million retweets?
- The #NuggsForCarter campaign went on to surpass Ellen DeGeneres’s famous Oscars selfie as Twitter’s most-retweeted post at the time.

45.

WENDY'S



46.

- Tennessee’s tallest building, a 33-storey tower in Nashville opened in 1994 and long known for its phone company tenant, has two tall spires and a dark glass face.
- Locals say it looks like the masked head of which comic-book hero, whose name gives the tower its nickname?



46.

BATMAN building



47.

- For decades, the packaging of this brand featured one of Europe’s most recognisable peaks.
- In 2023, after part of its production was moved from Bern to Bratislava, the brand was forced to rethink this familiar element of its packaging, replacing the peak with a more generic geometric design.
- Which brand was affected?

47.

TOBLERONE



48.

- Which Caribbean country is the only one among the 35 sovereign countries of the Americas to feature on the UN’s list of 44 least developed countries (LDCs)?
- It became the second independent republic in the Americas, after the United States.

48.

HAITI



Spare Questions

Only if a question is withdrawn

S1.

- A 1966 patent associated with Fredric J. Baur helped lay the groundwork for a snack launched two years later.
- Its design married a rigid container with pieces shaped like miniature saddles, curving one way along one axis and the opposite way along another.
- This unusual geometry helped the pieces nest together in a remarkably uniform stack.
- **Which snack brand** was born from this combination of form and function?

S1.

PRINGLES



S2.

- Founded in 2016, the parent company of several Indian personal-care brands built its identity around three principles: natural, safe and honest.
- Its portfolio includes brands spanning baby care, skincare and beauty.
- **What is the legal name of this corporate parent?**

S2.

HONASA Consumer Ltd

S3.

- **This Hungarian-born owner** of the New York World pioneered the modern newspaper layout, with bold headlines, pictures and comic strips, and undercover reporting by stars like Nellie Bly.
- He raised money from readers for the Statue of Liberty’s pedestal, and his sales war with Hearst helped give rise to yellow journalism.
- Who?

S3.

Joseph PULITZER



That’s the game

Scores in, please